

2026 Kansas Men's Baseball Assn Federal League Rules

All players must be rostered and registered (for insurance purposes) with Kansas Men's Baseball Association and play with sportsmanship as priority one.

Players should understand the purpose of this league is to play baseball, have fun and respect all players, umpires, and guests attending the games. Sportsmanship, respecting opponents, umpires and fans is a high priority.

Players:

- It is recommended that players be 30 years of age or older or have a **skillset and experience that is appropriate for the level of competition in the Federal League.**
- Please avoid players who are current, former professional athletes or someone whose skill level is advanced beyond the Federal League. Please avoid using current or recent high school and/or college athletes who have a skill level that is beyond the Federal League. Pitchers throwing more than 65mph are deemed to skillful for the league.

A review of a player can take place if a player's skill level is too advanced.

It will include:

Independent managers from other teams and the league Commissioner.

Players deemed to be advanced beyond the overall skill level of the League shall be removed from the team's roster. That player can join another KMBA League that is more appropriate for their skill level.

Game Time:

- No new inning shall start after 1 hour 55 minutes
- Game ends at 2 hours and 15 minutes.
- Games tied in score after 7+ innings will be allowed continue if time allows.
- Extra innings will begin with 0 out.
- Each team will place their last batted out at second base
- Games can end in a tie.
- If a doubleheader is played (as a result of rainouts) it will be 5 innings each game with no new inning starting after 1 hour 40 minutes. The game will end at 2 hours.

7 runs maximum per inning:

- Except:
 - a home run hit over the fence, all runs exceeding 7 count
 - seventh inning – no limit (only if the game reaches 7 actual innings)
 - extra inning – no limit

Game ending run rule:

- When trailing by 15 or more runs, the losing team has the choice to end the game.
- After 4 1/2 innings if the visiting team is the losing team
OR
- After 5 innings the home team is the losing team
- A game will be considered a full game after 4 innings in the event of inclement weather that may occur.

No bunting:

- A batter showing bunt, but without contact made will be a called strike
- If the batter makes contact, fair or foul, the batter will be called out and runners will return to their original base

No stealing:

- Base runners may advance on a ball that goes outside the “dirt” circle around home plate. The “dirt” circle area includes the ball going off the catcher into fair or foul territory.
- Runners may advance on an errant throw from the catcher to the pitcher and the pitcher to the fielder at a base during a pickoff play.
- Runners can start moving to the next base once the pitcher goes into their throwing motion.

Courtesy Runners:

- Courtesy runners (for pitchers, catchers or those with a leg/foot injury) **will be the last batted out**. At the start of a game if there are no outs and a courtesy runner is needed; the initial courtesy runner must be the batter who is third from the bottom of the line-up. If a second courtesy runner is needed, that courtesy runner must be the batter who is second from the bottom of the line-up.
- At two outs, when a catcher is on base or reaches base, they must use a courtesy runner. No exceptions. This is done for time purposes to keep the game moving without delays.

Uniforms:

- All players must be outfitted in matching team uniforms and hats with a number on the back of the jersey.

Safety Measure:

- To reduce leg injuries, a batter hitting the ball (on a fly or on the ground) into the outfield grass shall not be thrown out at first base. However, if there are runners on base, those runners can be forced out at 2nd, 3rd and home.
- If a ball is fielded “deep in the hole” by 3B, SS, 2B or 1B, that fielder, who has athletically moved during the play to the OF grass, can throw out the runner at 1B. (An infielder playing in a “shift” which places them in the OF grass may not throw out a runner).
- Runners should avoid collisions at a base when possible. Purposefully running into a defender may lead to ejection and suspension for future games.

Time saving measures:

- A new pitcher entering a game is allowed NO MORE than 8 warm-up pitches
- A returning pitcher is allowed NO MORE than 6 warm-up pitches
- After completion of warm-up pitches, no “around the horn” will be attempted. The ball is to be returned to the pitcher to begin play.
- After one or more outs are made, no “around the horn” will be attempted. The ball is to be returned to the pitcher to begin play.

EQUIPMENT

Wood or wood composite bats are the only bats permitted. Metal or metal composite bats are not permitted.

All players must wear a batting helmet when at-bat and as a runner on the bases.

WEATHER

Inclement weather games will be made up at the end of the regular season. If there are more than three inclement weather games, weekdays will be considered for makeup games starting in July.

Games will be postponed if the heat index hits 105 degrees. Games will be postponed when lightning is within 10 miles of facility as determined by a weather app, park attendant and both skippers.

Common sense will also be used by all parties.

CHAMPION

The Federal League Champion will be determined by a **four-team playoff if there are eight teams** in the league. The top four teams will play in the tournament. Team with best regular-season record will be seeded 1. Team with second best regular-season record will be seeded 2. Team with third best regular-season record will be seeded 3. Team with fourth best regular-season record will be seeded 4.

If there are six or seven teams in the Federal League, the top two teams will play a one-game championship.

The highest seed in each round will serve as the home team during playoffs. Team 1 v. Team 4 and Team 2 v Team 3.

Tie-breakers for regular-season final standings are 1. Head-to-head record. 2. Total runs allowed against the tied team. 3. Total runs scored against the tied team. 4. Total runs allowed against all teams. 5. Total runs scored against all teams.

(NOTE: The runs allowed takes preference to encourage quality defense as opposed to blowout scores)

Teams may not bring in new players for their playoff rosters. Rosters will be finalized at game 13 of the regular season.